

SOC INCIDENT REPORT

Incident ID: SOC-2026-002

Case Reference: CASO-SOC-BOTS-02

Status: ESCALATED TO L2 / IR

Severity: HIGH

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Environment: Splunk Enterprise / BOTS v2

Detection Source: Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational (Event ID 1 & Event ID 3)

INCIDENT SUMMARY

Successful malicious code execution was confirmed on the internal host **venus.frothly.local (10.0.1.101)**.

A heavily obfuscated, Base64-encoded PowerShell command was executed under the FROTHLY\service3 account. The command used hidden-window and encoded-command options (-w 1 and -enc). Deobfuscation revealed an in-memory AMSI bypass (AmsiUtils.amsiInitFailed), an RC4 decryption routine, and an outbound request using System.Net.WebClient to external infrastructure at **45.77.65.211**.

Further process-creation analysis showed PowerShell spawning Python (C:\python27\python.exe dns.py) from C:\temp\download\. Sysmon Event ID 3 confirmed an outbound TCP connection from 10.0.1.101:54940 to 45.77.65.211:443, demonstrating successful external communication from the compromised host.

KEY FINDINGS

- Affected host: venus.frothly.local / 10.0.1.101
- User context: **FROTHLY\service3**
- Primary process: powershell.exe
- Execution flags: **-noP -sta -w1 -enc**
- Evasion technique: In-memory AMSI bypass
- Secondary process: **C:\python27\python.exe dns.py**
- Working directory: C:\temp\download\
- External IP: 45.77.65.211
- Destination: 45.77.65.211:443/TCP
- Requested URI: /admin/get.php
- Network event: Sysmon Event ID 3
- Connection: 10.0.1.101:54940 -> 45.77.65.211:443
- Cookie session: session=MvCdddPqFQ54VL4OWU5ryTUir8=

ASSESSMENT

Successful malicious code execution and endpoint compromise were confirmed.

The attacker successfully executed an encoded PowerShell payload on the victim

host. The payload contained defense-evasion and staging functionality, including an AMSI bypass, RC4 decryption routine, and external retrieval capabilities.

The subsequent execution of C:\python27\python.exe dns.py from a temporary directory indicates that the activity progressed beyond the initial PowerShell execution. Sysmon Event ID 3 also confirmed successful outbound communication with the external IP 45.77.65.211.

The observed activity is consistent with post-exploitation and C2 activity. However, the available telemetry does not by itself confirm the exact purpose of dns.py, successful data exfiltration, persistence, or lateral movement.

L1 ACTION / DISPOSITION

- Incident escalated to Tier 2 (L2) / Incident Response (IR).
- Network isolation of venus.frothly.local recommended to prevent further communication, lateral movement, or potential data transfer.
- Block 45.77.65.211 at available firewall and web-proxy controls.
- Reset credentials associated with FROTHLY\service3 if account compromise is confirmed.
- L2/DFIR should collect and analyze C:\temp\download\, including dns.py, and review relevant endpoint, memory, authentication, and network artifacts.

EVIDENCE

1. Sysmon Event ID 1 showing PowerShell execution and subsequent Python process creation.
2. CyberChef deobfuscation of the PowerShell payload, confirming an AMSI bypass, RC4 decryption routine, and WebClient request to <https://45.77.65.211:443/admin/get.php>.
3. Sysmon Event ID 3 confirming an outbound connection from 10.0.1.101:54940 to 45.77.65.211:443.

LAB ENVIRONMENT

This incident is a simulated SOC investigation performed using the Boss of the SOC (BOTS) v2 dataset and Splunk Enterprise. The document is formatted as an L1 incident report for portfolio purposes.